Mayo Clinic Research Fellows' Association (MRFA)

MRFA Research Day Florida 2026

Thursday, October 29, 2026 · 8:00 AM – 2:30 PM · Kinne Auditorium, Mayo Clinic Florida

Program, abstracts, Q&A and ratings

8:00 AM–9:00 AM **Registration and breakfast**

9:00 AM–9:15 AM **Welcome and opening remarks**
Regina Castaneda, MD, MRFA Florida Chair and Sebastian Fernandez-Bussy, MD, Dean of Research

9:15 AM–10:30 AM Oral and rapid-fire presentations I

Moderator: Regina Castaneda, MD

9:15	ORAL	**Victor Bodart-Santos, PhD**	**Targeting P2RX7 to Suppress Innate Immune Activation Induced by Extracellular Vesicles Carrying Mitochondrial Cargo in Tauopathy**
9:25	RAPID	Jie Hu, MD, PhD	Development of a Novel KrasFLEx-G12D Mouse Model for Kras-driven Cancer Research
9:30	RAPID	Andres Monge Ferrin, MD	Wheelchair Propulsion Type and Musculoskeletal Burden After Spinal Cord Injury
9:35	ORAL	**Paola Suarez Meade, MD**	**Single-cell spatial multi-omic mapping of glioblastoma reveals two targetable invasion programs and a margin invasion burden that predicts early progression**
9:45	RAPID	Jaime I. Castillo Silva, MD	Unraveling Menopause: Four Distinct Symptom Phenotypes
9:50	RAPID	Maya Learmonth	Combining Mesenchymal Stromal Cell-Conditioned Media with Contemporary Pharmacotherapy Modulates Hyperglycemic Kidney Tubular Injury and Geroprotective Signaling In Vitro
9:55	ORAL	**Alfredo Verastegui, MD**	**Cardiac Structural Recovery with GLP-1 Receptor Agonist Therapy in Heart Failure: A Multicenter Propensity-Matched Study**
10:05	RAPID	Ekin Inal, MD	MAP Score and Abdominal Aortic Calcium Score Capture Distinct Operative and Renal Risk in Partial Nephrectomy: A Single-Center Retrospective Study
10:10	RAPID	Wenhui Qiao, PhD	APOE genotype modulates glial responses and myelin homeostasis during aging
10:15	ORAL	**Leonardo Ospino**	**Adverse Childhood Experiences and Functional Outcomes Following Interdisciplinary Pain Rehabilitation: A Retrospective Cohort Study**
10:25	RAPID	Thomas Sears, PhD	Prolonged Vorasidenib Treatment Accelerates Growth in a Subset of High-Grade IDH-Mutant Glioma Cultures

10:30 AM–11:30 AM **Poster session I**
31 posters, P-01 to P-31 · Set up 8:00–9:00 AM · remove by 11:30 AM

11:30 AM–12:00 PM **Lunch**

12:00 PM–1:15 PM Oral and rapid-fire presentations II

Moderator: Regina Castaneda, MD

12:00	ORAL	**Grace Samtani, PhD**	**Therapeutic potential of antisense oligonucleotide targeting of Tau Tubulin Kinase 1 in models of Alzheimer's disease**
12:10	RAPID	Diego Sepulveda, MD	What Patients Want: Are Weight-Loss Goals Realistic Relative to the Strategies Patients Are Willing to Adopt?
12:15	RAPID	Srabasti Sengupta, PhD, MS	Metabolic modulations of CAR T cells to improve anti-tumor efficacy in Glioblastoma
12:20	ORAL	**Andrea Muniz, MD**	**Optimal window for lactic acid clearance after Impella 5.5 placement in patients with cardiogenic shock**
12:30	RAPID	Fan Wang, PhD	Information That Sparks Dialogue: Supporting Clinical Trial Communication Through an AI-Enabled Portal
12:35	RAPID	Ayaka Tatsumoto, PhD	Humanized MAPT and APP Increase Neuronal Excitability and Accelerate Phosphorylated Tau Propagation in a Novel Entorhinal Cortex Layer II–Targeted Mouse Model of Early Alzheimer's Disease
12:40	ORAL	**Diego Sanchez-Calderin, MD**	**Early Revascularization in Symptomatic Carotid Artery Disease Leads to Better Outcomes: A Ten-Year Multi-Center Cohort Analysis**
12:50	RAPID	Rijan Kafle, MBBS	Impact of Extracorporeal Membrane Oxygenation as a Bridge to Lung Transplantation on Perioperative Outcomes, Renal Trajectory and Resource Utilization
12:55	RAPID	Ahmed Saad, MD	Epilepsy as a Marker of Cognitive Decline in Cerebral Amyloid Angiopathy: Evidence from a Large Multi-Institutional Cohort
1:00	ORAL	**Yugant Khand, MBBS**	**Risk of Incident Seizures and Epilepsy After a Diagnosis of Idiopathic Intracranial Hypertension: A Matched Retrospective Cohort Study**
1:10	RAPID	Alexis J. Magana, MD	The Predictive Value of SHAPE Test in Predicting Perioperative Major Adverse Cardiac Events: A Single-Center Retrospective Analysis

1:15 PM–2:15 PM **Poster session II**
31 posters, P-32 to P-63 · Set up 11:30 AM–12:00 PM · remove by 2:15 PM

2:15 PM–2:30 PM **Awards ceremony and closing remarks**
Best Full Oral Presentation, Best Rapid-Fire Presentation, Best Poster Presentation and Audience Choice Award

Program, abstracts and live Q&A: mrfa-florida.github.io/research-day-2026

Oral talks 10 min · Rapid-fire 5 min · Program subject to change